

Planning for RDM checklist:

This template contains the key ideas and guiding questions from the “Planning for RDM” mini-module. You can download a copy, print it, jot notes in the margins, and use it to structure conversations and questions with your thesis supervisor.

Stage 1: Planning for *Research Ideas*

Once you've defined a clear research question, you will define which research data and supporting artefacts are needed for your project:

- ✓ Identify types of research objects you will need to generate or re-use.
 - ☐ Which research data are necessary to answer your research question(s)?
 - ☐ Which supporting artefacts do you need to collect during your research project?

- ✓ Evaluate whether the data will involve personal data, copyrighted data or proprietary data
 - ☐ Does your research involve data collected from humans? If yes, you are likely working with personal data and ethical guidelines will apply.
 - ☐ Are you re-using data collected by or created by others? If yes, what type of license does it have?
 - ☐ Are you doing an internship and using a company's data? What are the terms of your graduation agreement?

- ✓ Identify whether ethical or legal approvals are needed and how long these take. If your project involves collecting or re-using data that came from human research subjects, it requires an HREC application. Ask yourself:
 - ☐ Is this feasible given your project timeline? If not, how can you alter your research methodology?

Stage 2: Planning for *Research Data and Design*

In the planning and design phase, you must plan for data storage and formatting.

- ✓ While you're m working on your project, where will you store the research data?

- ☐ What amount of storage space is needed?
- ☐ What's the degree of sensitivity and/or confidentiality of the data?
- ☐ Are you working with collaborators who will need access to the data?
- ✓ Which file format(s) are the most appropriate for the data?
 - ☐ Are the formats interoperable so the data are easily re-usable?
 - ☐ Which file formats are commonly used in your field?

Stage 3: Planning for *Data Collection*

- ✓ How will you collect the data?
 - ☐ Can you describe your planned experimental methods in detail?
- ✓ How will you document your research methods?
 - ☐ Which documentation strateg(ies) do you plan to use?
- ✓ Which file and folder structures will you use for your project?
 - ☐ Can you describe your file naming schema?
- ✓ How will you track changes or do version control for code and software?

Stage 4: Planning for *Data Processing & Analysis*

- ✓ How will you distinguish between the raw versus processed project data?
 - ☐ Recommended: save the raw data in one folder, processed data in another
- ✓ What units will the data be collected in?
- ✓ How will you document the steps you took between the data, your analysis methods, and your results?
- ✓ How will you minimise the risk of data leaks?
 - ☐ It's important to be intentional in planning safety precautions to avoid data breaches.

Stage 5: Planning for *Data Publishing, Preservation, Re-use*

- ✓ Which project data should be shared publicly vs. archived internally vs. deleted?
- ✓ What supporting documentation should you submit with your final report to make the data and code understandable and re-usable by others?
- ✓ If you are publishing your work, which repository is the most appropriate for long-term storage?
- ✓ How will you license the data collected for your thesis project?